

CELEBRATING EXCELLENCE: A SPOTLIGHT ON SAI DANDEKAR, A TRAILBLAZER IN INTERNATIONAL LAW

In the intricate realm of international law, one senior lawyer has emerged as a beacon of innovation and leadership: Sai Dandekar. With over a decade of experience, particularly in the construction and engineering sectors, Sai has established herself as an expert in managing complex legal transactions and disputes across various jurisdictions.

Currently, she serves as Legal Counsel at a prominent engineering and environmental consultancy, where she plays a pivotal role in providing legal support to the organisation and its numerous international subsidiaries. Her responsibilities encompass overseeing group reorganisations and meticulously evaluating commercial contracts, ensuring that legal risks are effectively mitigated throughout the different phases of projects. Sai's proficiency in cross-border transaction management and risk assessment is vital in aligning legal strategies with the company's key business objectives.

Before her current role, Sai excelled as a Senior Associate at a leading global law firm. In that capacity, she managed non-contentious matters, contributing to significant projects across multiple sectors, including energy and construction. Her aptitude for drafting bespoke contracts and navigating complex negotiations has made her a trusted advisor to clients facing intricate legal challenges.

Renowned for her strategic approach to legal risk management and cost control, Sai possesses expertise in both common law and civil law systems, allowing her to adeptly navigate the complexities of international transactions. Throughout her career, she has represented clients in high-stakes negotiations while collaborating with international law firms and appointing experts to enhance her legal strategies.

Sai's impressive track record has garnered well-deserved recognition. In 2023, she was honoured as one of "The Most Admired Global Indians" by a prestigious publication and received the Prominent Women in International Law award from a respected legal alliance. These accolades reflect her influence and unwavering commitment to advancing the legal profession, particularly in international contexts.



Her tenure as General Counsel at Shapoorji Pallonji Mideast LLC further solidified her reputation as a formidable legal mind in the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) region. Her nominations for the GC Power List Middle East 2019 and her finalist status for the General Counsel of the Year at the ACC Middle East Legal Awards highlight her exceptional contributions to the field. In addition to her legal practice, Sai has authored articles on a variety of legal topics, significantly enriching the body of knowledge in international law and construction practices.

Fluent in English, Hindi, and Marathi, with beginner-

level proficiency in Arabic, Sai exemplifies the global nature of contemporary legal practice. Her diverse background and comprehensive skill set provide her clients and the legal community with invaluable perspectives.

As she continues to break barriers and redefine success in international law, Sai Dandekar serves as an inspiration for aspiring lawyers, particularly women in the field. Her unwavering commitment to excellence, integrity, and strategic foresight embodies the values that underpin her illustrious career and positions her as a leader in the ever-evolving landscape of global legal practice.